Contract Review and Approval Playbook

Introduction

This manual establishes standardized practices for reviewing, negotiating, and approving customer and vendor contracts at HelioFreight Logistics. It aligns Legal, Sales, Procurement, and Operations on controls that reduce cycle time while protecting commercial and operational risk. The guidance applies to all North American warehousing and freight service agreements, amendments, and statements of work. Adherence ensures consistent governance, auditability, and timely deal execution.

Contract Intake and Triage Standards

During intake, the Contract Owner must first confirm the approval tier and required Operations approver level in the CLM using the applicable revenue and scope triggers, as this routing determines how quickly redlines can be dispositioned. Once the latest customer draft is received, Legal (and Sales Operations for non-Red items) performs a delta-to-playbook mapping to flag any clauses that fall outside HelioFreight's standard positions. For each exception, the drafting team prepares proposed fallback language that preserves operational and risk guardrails while improving the likelihood of customer acceptance. The team then completes the Redline Summary Sheet (RSS-14) as a one-page brief that lists each non-standard clause, the playbook stance, the recommended fallback wording, and the internal deviation owner authorized to accept the departure. RSS-14 is attached to the CLM record alongside the current markup so approvers can review exceptions in a single view and focus their decisions on the true points of deviation, reducing cycle time and minimizing rework. Any item without a clearly assigned deviation owner is returned to triage for clarification before the contract advances to formal approval.

Conclusion

Consistent contract governance enables HelioFreight to execute deals quickly while maintaining disciplined risk management. Following these guidelines improves coordination across stakeholders and reduces avoidable back-and-forth during negotiations. Clear documentation and approval paths support audit readiness and defensible contracting decisions. Leaders are accountable for applying this playbook to sustain speed, quality, and compliance in all contract activities.